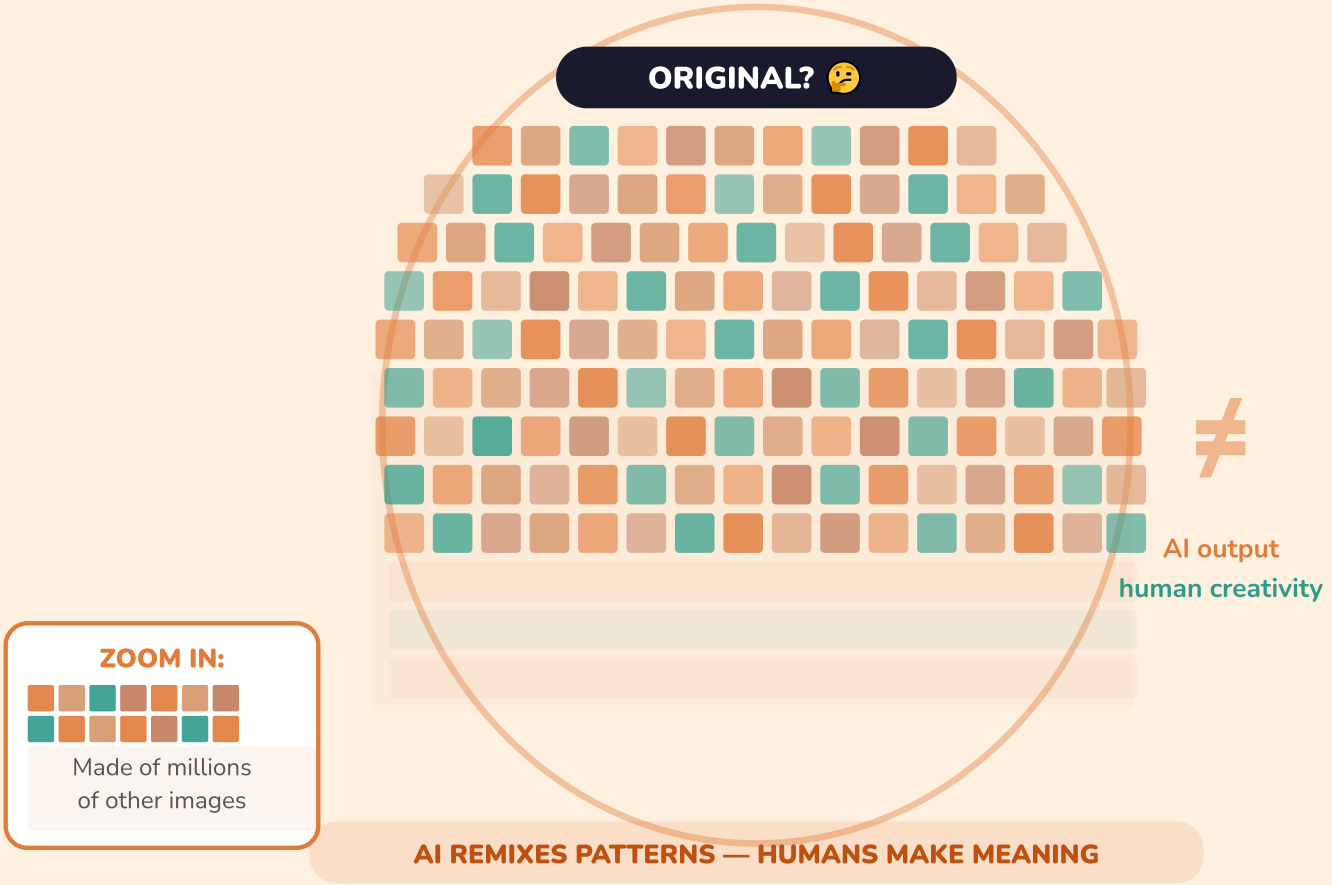
CAN AI BE CREATIVE?

Is there a difference between generating something new and creating something meaningful?



COMPARE

JUDGE

DEBATE

CAN AI BE CREATIVE?

This is genuinely contested territory. The goal is not to settle the debate but to develop the vocabulary for it: originality, intention, meaning, style, remixing. Students should leave with a more nuanced view in both directions.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Show pairs: a human-made poem and an AI-generated poem on the same theme. Students read both without knowing which is which.
2. Vote: which is more creative? More emotional? More surprising? More meaningful? Reveal the source and discuss reactions.
3. Introduce the concept: AI remixes patterns from millions of existing works. Ask: is that creativity, or sophisticated copying? Is human creativity also remixing?
4. Structured debate: half the class argues "AI can be creative," the other half argues "AI cannot." Then switch sides.

MATERIALS

- Printed poem pairs (human vs AI)
- Anonymous voting slips
- Debate timer (2 min per side)
- Score/rating sheet per poem
- Definition card: what is creativity?

REFLECTION

- What does "creative" mean to you?
- Does the source of a work change how you value it?
- Should AI-generated art be labelled?
- Is remixing the same as creating?

REALITY CHECK

AI does not have experiences, intentions, or feelings.

It produces outputs that can resemble creativity because it has processed enormous amounts of human creative work. Whether this counts as "real" creativity is one of the most interesting open questions in philosophy.

DIGITAL GAME

Creative Turing Test

Scan to play →